

Johann Ravindranathan

Geog 450

3/7/26

Happy Places in Seattle

Intro

For this project we created a story of life in Seattle as a class. We invented fictional characters who live and study in Seattle. We created a dataset of places visited by our characters and the stories they wrote about them. The data was processed and turned into infographics, which provide insights into the lifestyle of our characters during their time in Seattle.

Process

The first step was collecting data. We each traveled, along with a pet balloon, to a location with personal meaning. We took a picture of our balloon with the background and wrote a story explaining why our characters enjoyed that place. The pictures and stories were uploaded to a shared Padlet sheet [1]. The total set of images and stories was downloaded into a CSV file.

The next task was cleaning the dataset. After removing irrelevant columns, the important remaining columns were the short stories and a unique label for each location. My labels were general descriptors of the location. I included a second set of labels, more specific than the first, and new column for the number of words per short story.

The stories were trimmed for brevity using a replacement function. Unimportant words were replaced with quotation marks, and the trimmed stories were saved to a new column. Another new column tracked the number of words per shortened story.

Figure 1: TreeMap of the different locations and stories

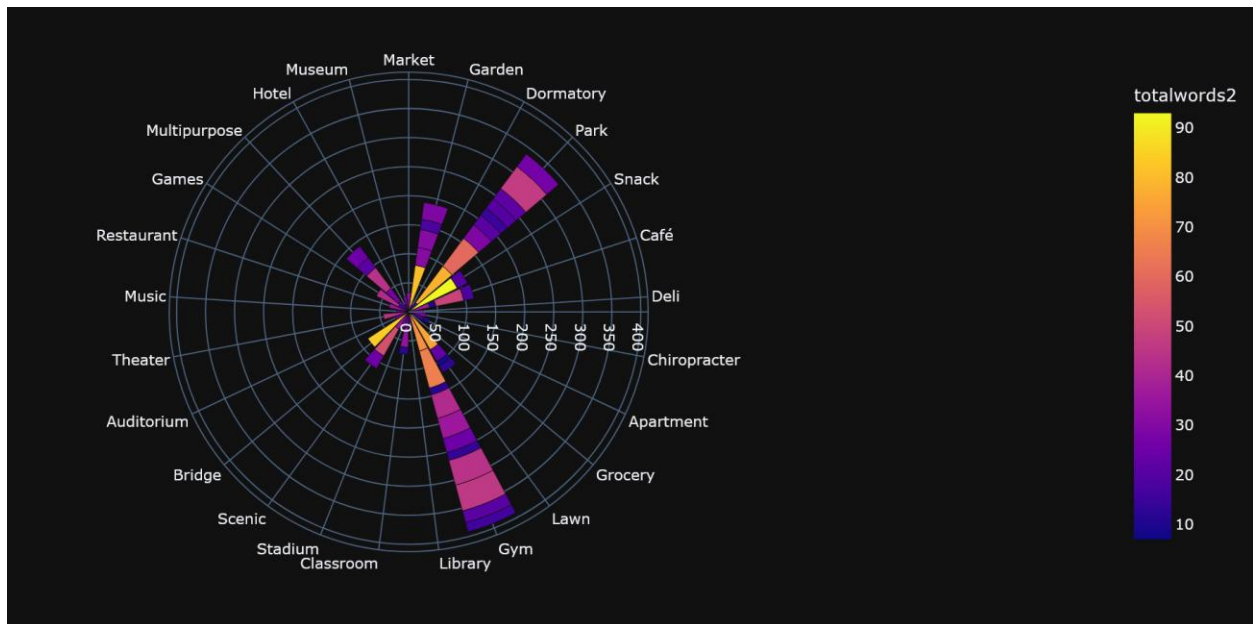


Reviewing the TreeMap shows clear deficiencies in the story cleaning. The clarity of the stories has suffered. Missing details, or choppy word replacement, mean locational and sentimental information is lost in some stories.

Other errors or oddities also appear. There are two separate **Types** of Dwelling, when there should only be one. The **SpecType** Games appears in both the Recreation and Food **Types**. The location under Food was both a game-store and restaurant, so I made a distinction.

Still, the interactivity of the TreeMap makes reading less tedious. Despite labeling issues, the TreeMap shows the general trends of our character's movements. These can be corroborated with the second infographic, the Polar Bar Chart.

Fig 2: Polar Bar Chart from same stories and locations



The Polar Bar Chart uses the **totalwords2**, **SpecType**, and **CleanBodyWrap** columns. The outer layer displays the different specific locations visited by our character. Entries for each **SpecType** are stacked, with size scaled by **totalwords2**.

Comparing the two infographics, our character frequented Gyms and Parks more than other locations. Most of these gym visits were to the IMA on/near campus. The cleaning function introduces some uncertainty, but our character generally had the most to say about the outdoor Recreational areas.

Reflection

My implementation for creating **CleanBody** / **CleanBodyWrap** needs refinement. Some of the issues stem from variations in writing style and typos. Removing our names and the characters' names proved a hassle. If these details were included in a different column than **Body**, trimming the stories might have been easier. Nonetheless more tinkering is needed to produce the best shortened story. Shortening the stories was a necessary process, otherwise the large outputs would cause severely miniaturized text. More fine-tuning is needed for the correct balance of brevity and clarity.

If not for these issues, I'm pleased with the organization of the TreeMap and Polar Bar Chart. The TreeMap did well at displaying the relationships between locations. The Polar Bar Chart was effective for displaying the number of interactions and probably scales better with dataset size.

They both paint a consistent picture of our / our characters' movements and the places frequented by university students in Seattle. I learned several new locations through my classmates' stories. With an improved cleaning process this would translate well to the infographics. As it is, they show highly active individuals who travel Seattle and have found a variety of places that bring them peace and happiness during their time at UW.

Resources:

1. Oh, Gunwha. "Happy Place Winter26." Padlet, 24 Feb. 2026, padlet.com/gunwhaoh/happy-place-winter26-i33k3qtcvgp38mxa.
 - a. (Padlet Link): <https://padlet.com/gunwhaoh/happy-place-winter26-i33k3qtcvgp38mxa>
2. Ravindranathan, Johann. "Geog 450 Copy of TextDataProcessingHP24.Ipynb." Google Colab, Google, 3 Mar. 2026, colab.research.google.com/drive/11gOdly4Uq7icgDYYZ2wGSEDJHzv3Sasi?authuser=1#scrollTo=CFICoBBisfYR.
 - a. (My Colab Notebook Link): <https://colab.research.google.com/drive/11gOdly4Uq7icgDYYZ2wGSEDJHzv3Sasi?authuser=1#scrollTo=CFICoBBisfYR>